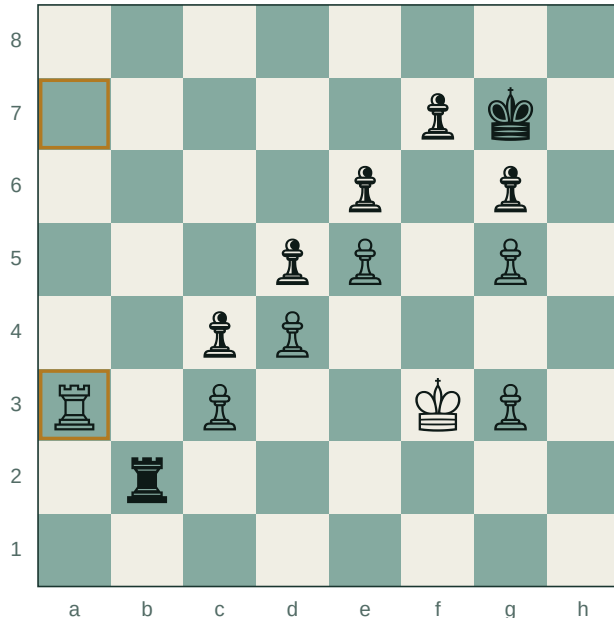


# Interference tactics: Black, move 45

Interference tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 45.Ra3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**45...Rb3 46. Ra1 Rxc3+**

**45...Rb3** The rook moves from b2 to b3. Recorded reply: **46.Ra1**.

**46...Rxc3+** Check restricts White to 5 legal replies here. The move also takes the pawn on c3.

At the end, nominal material is White 9 / Black 10 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

**CHECKPOINT**

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +1:** the balance goes from +0 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

Capturing the interposing piece may restore defense. Calculate which captures are legal and whether they permit another tactic.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

Interference interrupts a defensive line between enemy pieces. Occupying one square can make a previously protected target vulnerable or prevent an important recapture.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Trace the defender's line to its target and inspect forcing moves onto the intervening squares.

The defending king is on f3. Geometrically undefended: rook on a3. Check for tactical protection.